

sold than all of the Android tablet sales combined. Talk about wiping the floor with the competition.

- **2011** - The second generation iPad made the jump from a single core A4 chip to a dual core A5 chip (garnering an impressive 66% performance increase!), shed some weight and thickness and got dual front and rear facing cameras to facilitate video calls. It still featured the same low-res screen as its predecessor but also the same 10 hr battery life. A definite upgrade over the iPad 1, but Apple shot themselves in the foot with the pricing – \$639 wasn't really spare change. Sales tanked a bit but still people bought into it, probably because they heard from their friends how good the original iPad was. The iPad 2 also holds the distinction of the only iOS device to support 6 major iOS versions, from iOS 4 to iOS 9.
- **2012** - The third generation iPad introduced one of the most compelling reasons to pick up an iPad ever yet – a Retina display. Or rather, a display that is high-res enough that your eyes can't pick out individual pixels on the screen. The usual suite of processor upgrades followed too, with much improved graphical processing, FHD video recording and LTE support (at least in the States anyway, rest of the world was still a far cry away from 4G). It wasn't a bad device by any means but it only had about 7 months in the limelight before Apple dropped the 4th gen iPad upon the world.
- **2012 (again)** - It would've been perplexing for a company like Apple to launch a product so soon into its lifecycle if not for the absolutely massive upgrades that it brought to the table. The new A6X chip was roughly twice as good as the previous A5X chip giving the iPad a little more oomph in productivity related tasks and gaming especially. This one also got the Lightning port, Apple's new proprietary connector. The device enjoyed more its share of positive reviews from reviewers although a lot of iPad 3 owners were disgruntled by the sudden mid cycle upgrade.
- **2017** - After a huge hiatus out of the limelight (and the diversification of the iPad lineup), the OG series returned back with a bang, with the cheapest iPad ever released. They basically just took the iPad Air 1 chassis and crammed a lot of pretty new components into it like the fast A9 SOC. There were some cost cutting measures, like not having a laminated screen (leading to a pretty huge airgap between the bezel and the actual screen) but at \$330 base price, it's kind of hard to argue.

iPad Air

This lineup was also one of Apple's most prolific, with reviewers even